TECHNICAL WRITING · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Client Onboarding Process for Zoho Books

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> **Purpose:** To ensure a consistent, efficient, and client-friendly onboarding experience when setting up new clients in Zoho Books for bookkeeping and automation services.

Step 1: Initial Setup & Access

1. Create a New Organization in Zoho Books

- Navigate to the dashboard.
- Click the dropdown next to the current organization name >

> *"Manage Organizations" > "Create Organization".*

- Choose the correct region (e.g., US, UK, Canada, Nigeria).
- Fill in client business details (Name, Industry, Currency, FY Start).

2. Assign Internal Team Roles

- Go to Settings > Users > Invite User
- Assign roles based on Automate Accounts' internal structure:
- Bookkeeper (Standard Access)
- Automation Specialist (Admin)
- Reviewer (View-Only Access)

3. Enable Client Portal Access

- Still under Settings > Client Portal
- Customize welcome message.
- Toggle ON portal access for client.

- Auto-send invite link to the client’s primary email.

Step 2: Chart of Accounts Customization

1. Review Default Accounts

- Go to Settings > Chart of Accounts
- Remove irrelevant accounts (e.g., if the client doesn’t deal with inventory).
- 2. Add Custom Accounts
- Based on the client’s industry (e.g., Consulting, E-commerce), add:
- Income Categories: “Freelance Revenue,” “Course Sales”
- Expense Categories: “Virtual Assistant Costs,” “Zoom Subscription”

Step 3: Automations & Workflows

1. Recurring Invoices Setup

- Go to Sales > Recurring Invoices
- Set frequency, auto-email settings, and invoice templates
- Include payment terms (e.g., Net 7)

2. Payment Reminders

- Enable under Settings > Reminders
- Customize message tone (friendly but professional)
- Set triggers: e.g., 2 days before due, day of, 5 days after
- 3. Approval Workflows
- Go to Automation > Workflow Rules
- Example: Any invoice above $2,000 requires admin approval
- Create notification triggers for team leads

Step 4: Final Review & Client Walkthrough

1. Internal Review

- Bookkeeper and Automation Lead review entries for accuracy.
- Run a test invoice and a test payment.

2. Client Zoom Call (30 mins)

- Walk through the dashboard, invoicing, expense tracking, and

> *reports.*

- Address FAQs and next steps.
- Share a 1-page quick reference guide PDF (optional visual content in Canva).

Best Practices ● Always confirm the client’s primary currency and tax settings before sending the first invoice.

- Use custom templates with the client’s logo and Automate Accounts branding.
- Log all onboarding activity in the CRM with date, time, and notes.